



Cameras maketh a photo just as much as any photographer. Here's how YOU can test the former!

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The joy of capturing a great image is hard to describe and the credit, despite what some might tell you, is all yours. The camera has a big role to play for sure, but its role is only limited to that of a tool; you give Michael Schumaker your battered old Fiat and he'll still do things with it that you never thought was possible. A better camera, as with a better car, will only let you do so much and just because you have a Ferrari doesn't mean that you're a great driver.

Cameras come in a variety of shapes and sizes and are festooned with such a plethora of features that a layman is sure to be completely flustered by the choices on offer. Before we even begin considering testing, we need to understand the features that we're looking at.

Types of cameras

Cameras come in all shapes and sizes and each has their specific use-case. Here's a quick run-down of the form-factors that you need to care about:

- **Compact digital cameras:** These are the simplest and most compact cameras available today. Tiny, pocketable and usually boasting of a 3x to 8x zoom lens, these cameras are what you use when you want something that'll take images better than your phone,



but only if you're in no hurry to take those images. Point-n-shoot cameras are notably slow to respond and focus, especially in low-light and are designed for shooting set-pieces rather than action. There are some exceptions of course, but even those will never be as good as more advanced cameras.

- **Travel Zooms:** These are essentially point-n-shoot cameras with telescopic zoom. The zoom levels usually range from 20x-35x or more, allowing these cameras to zoom into the eye of a crow a hundred yards away if you so desire.

Regardless, other than that level of zoom, these cameras are no different from any other type of point-n-shoot and suffer the same drawbacks while costing as much as a cheap DSLR. We recommend that you completely ignore this category unless you're absolutely desperate for the longest optical zoom at the lowest price.

- **Mirrorless cameras:** DSLRs are large and bulky because their design incorporates a "reflex" mirror and prism system that adds to the bulk of the design. Mirrorless cameras don't have